



# The Unfinished Story

*A short story told in five weekly chapters, five minutes each. Every chapter ends on a choice with no clean answer, the form argues about what the character should do, and the next week opens by revealing what they actually did. It is about integrity: doing the right thing when nobody is watching. This is Volume One.*

## What you need

| Page   | What it is                                                                                    |
|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Slides | How it works, then the five chapters, one to a slide (a separate download). Nothing to print. |
| Page 2 | All five chapters in full, if you would rather read from the page                             |

## How it works

| Step | What happens                                                                                                          |
|------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | From chapter two on, start by reading what last week's choice actually led to.                                        |
| 2    | Read this week's chapter: a short scene ending on a new choice with no clean answer. One chapter a week, in order.    |
| 3    | Let the form argue it out. There is no need to settle on an answer, because the story continues next week either way. |

## Worth knowing

- Two minutes to read, then as long as you like to discuss.
- The recap at the start of each chapter is the reason to come back the following week, so keep the chapters in order.

***Make sure you come back for Volume Two. Follow @thepastoralguide to hear when it lands.***





# The Unfinished Story

*All five chapters, for reading straight from the page if you would rather not use the slides.*

## 1. The Bag by the Gate

On the walk to school, Sam spots a bag left behind at the bus stop. Inside: a phone, a bit of cash, and a house key. Nobody else is around, and the next bus is already pulling in.

**What should Sam do?**

## 2. The Assembly

**So far:** *Sam handed the bag straight to the school office. Three days later, a girl named Priya came looking for it. It was hers, and the only photo she has of her nan was inside.*

Priya wants to say thank you in assembly, in front of everyone. Sam feels strange about the attention, and quietly asks a friend not to mention it. The friend thinks Sam deserves the credit, and tells a teacher anyway.

**Was the friend right to tell, even though Sam didn't want the attention?**

## 3. The Empty Seat

**So far:** *The teacher mentioned it at the end of registration, one sentence rather than a whole assembly moment. Sam went red, but it passed quickly.*

A few weeks later, Sam notices someone being quietly left out. Not bullied exactly, just never asked to sit with the group at lunch, week after week.

**Is doing nothing about something like this the same as taking a side?**

## 4. What Sam Heard

**So far:** *Sam started sitting with them sometimes, without making it a whole thing.*

Then Sam finds out, from someone else, that this person said something unkind about Sam behind their back, months before any of this started.

**Does knowing that change what Sam should do now?**

## 5. Small Things

**So far:** *Sam kept sitting there anyway. It felt strange for about a week, and then it just felt normal.*

By the end of term, the two of them were just friends. Nobody made a big deal of it. Nobody even really noticed when it happened.

**Do small choices like Sam's actually add up to anything?**

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